Fr. Patrick Doherty 79642496 / Fr. Kieran O'Doherty 79642359
Sacristans: Glen 79643131/Maghera 79643061 Web Cam www.mcnmedia.live
Baptisms: 79642983(Notification by Thursday) Pastoral Centre:79642983
Pilgrim Statue: 79642983 / St Vincent de Paul Helpline: 07752111032
PARISH FACEBOOK PAGE – www.facebook.com/magheraparish
It's a useful way to stay up to date with all our parish events. Please hit the 'Follow' button and we would be grateful if you could like and share our posts.

Sunday:	St Patrick's	9.30am
	St Mary's	Vigil 6.30am and Sunday 11.30am
		Wednesday 7.30pm and Friday 10.00am
Daily Mass	St Patrick's	Monday to Thursday 9.30am
		Friday 7.30pm (Mass for all deceased)
		Daily Rosary at 9.10am

CONFESSIONS – Daily after Morning Mass (except Sunday and Holydays) & St Mary's at 7pm on Wednesday (before Evening Mass) and Saturday 11am/12Noon & 5.30pm/6.15pm

We pray that the men called to be priests of our diocese will know the truth of St Paul's words in our second reading. "There is nothing I cannot master with the help of the One who gives me strength". pgoh2111@gmail.com
Are you 18 years or older and thinking or wondering about serving the Church as a priest of the diocese of Derry? There will be an afternoon Talk with time for Prayer, Discussion, Questions & Answers in Derry today (Sunday 11 October) Contact: Fr. Pat O'Hagan at pgoh2111@gmail.com

HOLY FACE OF JESUS: – Prayers every Tuesday after 9.30am Mass and Divine Mercy.

OUR LADY UNTIER OF KNOTS NOVENA:
Begins in St Mary's Church on Wednesday evening 14 October after 7.30pm Mass and continues for nine Wednesdays.

OCTOBER DEVOTIONS:
In St Mary's Church each Sunday evening at 6pm during October.

CONFIRMATION - Bishop Router will administer the Sacrament of Confirmation to the P7 children of the parish on Wednesday 26 May at 3pm.
IRISH CONFIRMATION – will take place in St Patrick's Church, Dungiven on Saturday 17 April at 11am

FIRST COMMUNION DATES

St Mary's P.S., Glenview P.S	Saturday 15 May
BunScoil N.Bríd	Saturday 29 May
St Patrick's P.S., Glen	Saturday 5 June

ENVELOPE COLLECTION - Thank you for last week's envelope collections of £3,060.00. We appreciate your support to the church and for bringing your envelopes and donations to the church and pastoral centre. May your generosity be rewarded.
Anyone wishing to donate to Maghera parish may do so by visiting website: magheraparishderry.com and using donate button.

PRAY FOR THE NATIONAL GATHERING OF THE CHURCH IN IRELAND: - Bishops, priests, religious and lay people from across Ireland will gather for the National Synodal Assembly on Saturday 17 October, to pray, listen and discern what God may be asking of the Catholic Church in Ireland at this time. Bishop Michael Router and seven delegates will represent the Diocese of Derry. Please remember in your prayers, Bishop Michael, our diocesan delegates and everyone taking part. Find out more on https:derrydiocese.org/national-synodal-assembly

SENIORS TUESDAY CLUB In Fairhill Youth Centre on Tuesdays at 10.30am.

ERIGAL PARISH MISSION –will take place from 27 October to 2nd November. All are warmly welcome, whether from the parish or neighbouring communities. We invite you to join us for as much of the Mission as possible and to keep its success in your prayers. For more information, please visit:- https://www.errigalparish.com/

GLEN GAA Website www.wattygrahamsgac.com Lotto Numbers 40:25:28:33: No winner. Next week £13,000. No £50 winners. Flyover £16,800 in 45 Nos. or less.

FALLAGHLOON HALL - BINGO- Sunday night 7.30pm. Jackpot £500 in 45 numbers.

AN CARN - SET DANCING: CHAIR AEROBICS - Thurs 15 Oct from 9.30am/10.30am at An Carn. **Introduction to Punch Needle** – Learn the basics of punch-needle and create your own unique tufted piece of art to bring home! All levels welcome, especially beginners – on Saturday 17 Oct from 11am/1pm. £25. **Bilingual Comedy Night**: Funny Focail – Half trí Ghaeilge agus half through English, providing a space to practice and learn cúpla focal, and most importantly to have a laugh with comedians Diane O'Connor Louise O'Toole & Aideen McQueen! Saturday 24 October – at 7.30pm. Adm. £10.

DERRY DIOCESE YOUNG ADULT COMMUNITY – invites everyone aged 18-35 to join their new community every Tuesday evening at 7.30pm, starting 20 oct, at Claudy Pastoral Centre. Each week features a varied programme including invited speakers, scripture, prayer, food and fellowship, alongside organised social events. Everyone is welcome to come along! For more details, please contact yvonne.rooney@derrydiocese.org

GRANAGHAN & DISTRICT WOMEN'S GROUP – We will be delivering our first-ever Kids' Papier-mâché workshop during the Hallowe'en holidays on Tuesday 27 Oct from 1pm/3pm approximately. Our tutor will be Louie Winward. Louie is no stranger to Swatragh, but this will be her first time delivering a workshop for us. Open to boys and girls and geared towards 8–12-year-olds. Guaranteed to be messy but §marvellous. Parents welcome to stay too. Places allocated on a first come, first served basis.
Phone Anne McNicholl 07714757643.

MENTAL HEALTH FIRST AID TRAINING COURSE - will take place on 27th & 28th Oct from 9.30am/4.30pm in Heaney Homeplace, 45 Main Street, Bellaghy. Please Note – to be eligible to apply you must live within or directly deliver a service within the Northern HSC Trust area. E-mail: denise@cwsan.org or phone 07540969623

PUBLIC LECTURE – by Dr. Paul Shrimpton, writer, historian and scholar of St John Henry Newman. WHAT IS UNIVERSITY ACTUALLYT FOR? Newman's Idea of Human Flourishing at University - Monday 12 October in Queen's University, Belfast at 7pm

29th Sunday in Ordinary Time

18 October 2026

Mission Sunday

Stamped with His Image

They come to Jesus with a trap. The Pharisees, who hated the Roman tax, and the Herodians, who lived off it, suddenly the best of friends. Say pay the tax, and the crowd turns on him. Say don't, and Rome will. Either way, he loses.

Jesus asks for a coin. Notice that he does not have one; they do. They are carrying the emperor's face in their own pockets while they ask the question. Whose image is this? Caesar's. Then give Caesar what is Caesar's and give God what is God's.

The coin bears Caesar's image. What bears God's? We do. Every person in this church, every person on the street outside, was made in the image and likeness of God. Caesar can have his coin. God wants the whole of us. The tax is a small matter. The question Jesus leaves hanging is far bigger: have you given God what is stamped with his image?

The first reading says something surprising about power. God calls Cyrus, a pagan king who has never heard of him, "his anointed", and uses him to bring the exiles home. God is not confined to the people who know his name. He works through rulers, through strangers, through history itself, and his purpose is never in doubt.

Today is World Mission Sunday. We pray for, and support, the missionaries who carry the Gospel where Christ is still unknown, and we remember that Irish men and women have been doing that for centuries, supported in their work by prayer and aid. But mission is not only abroad. St Paul tells the Thessalonians that the Gospel came to them "as power

and as the Holy Spirit and as utter conviction". That is what we are meant to carry out of here into the mission territory of our own parishes and beyond.

This week, give God what is his, starting with yourself.

Fr Sean

Announcements

Last week's collections amounted to: ***Melmount:*** £2901.00; ***Sion Mills*****:** £1465.00. Thank you.

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 19 October after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm. The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Forty Hours *St. Mary's Church, Melmount Sunday 8 November – Monday 9 November.*

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism:

Oisin Padraig Robert McHugh

We congratulate the following couple who were recently united in the Sacrament of Marriage:

Aine Timoney and Stephen Harper

May they Rest in Peace

Deaths

Eamon Kelly, 57 Bridge Street

Anniversaries

Patrick Michael O'Sullivan, Barry Langan, Mary Tracey

Andrew Foley, John McPhilemy, Hughie Blee

Christine O'Reilly, Lizzie Cairns, Anne Rouse

Caoimhe O'Brien, James O'Gorman, Kathy Rouse

Eamon McCrory, Patrick O'Neill, Ryan McGonigle

Eugene Tinney

Mission Sunday Mission Sunday is today Sunday 18 October. The Annual Mission Sunday Collection will be taken up at all Masses. There is an envelope marked *'Mission Sunday'* in your box of envelopes for this collection. *Please make cheques payable to 'Melmount Parish' or 'Sion Mills Parish' depending on the Parish.* There are approximately 1,500 Irish born missionaries working in more than 80 countries. They continue to spread the Gospel through their work, their deep commitment to the people they serve and their Faith. On Mission Sunday please pray for them and give as generously as you can to the Mission Sunday collection.

Congratulations to the Confirmation Pupils (P7's) of Melmount and Sion Mills and the First Communion (P4's) and Confirmation (P7's) Pupils of the Gael Scoil who were enrolled on their preparation journey at the weekend.

Annual Service for the Dead The Annual Service in remembrance of deceased members of our families and parish will take place on Sunday 15 November at 4.00pm in St. Mary's Church, Melmount and at 6.00pm in St. Theresa's Church, Sion Mills. Families who have suffered a bereavement since November 2025 are asked to nominate a representative to carry a candle to the altar in commemoration of their dead. *(Candles will be provided).*

Legion of Mary will meet in the Green Room, behind St. Theresa's Church, Sion Mills each Monday evening at 7.30pm. New member's welcome.

Vocations St. Paul could have written this passage from today's Second Reading to our seminarians and to the men discerning their vocation: *'We know, brothers, that God loves you and that you have been chosen,*

because when we brought the Good News to you, it came to you not only as words, but as power and the Holy Spirit and as utter conviction.'

'Lectio Divina' There will be prayerful reading of the following Sunday's Gospel at 7.00pm on Wednesday evenings in the Green Room, St. Theresa's Church, Sion Mills.

Parish Draw Promoters should make their returns for October to the Parish Office tomorrow **Monday 19 October from 2.00pm - 4.30pm.** The Draw for October will take place on Thursday 22 October at 10.30am in the Parish Office.

Baptism Dates Melmount

November: Sunday 8; Saturday 14, 21 & 28.

December: Saturday 1&12; Sunday 3.

Baptisms will be at 3.30pm on a Saturday and 12.45pm on a Sunday.

Pilgrimage to Fatima 5 July 2027 for 7 Nights Led by *Spiritual Director:* Fr Sean O'Donnell. *Group Leader:* Patricia Moore. Direct daytime return flights from Belfast to Porto. *Cost:* £950.00 per person sharing. (£100.00 off per person if paid in full by 30 November 2026). *Accommodation:* Hotel Cinquentenario, *Full Board:* breakfast, lunch & dinner each day. Full religious programme. Guided Tour of Sanctuary & Basilica of Our Lady of the Rosary. Visits to Aljustrel & Valinhos. *Optional:* Travel insurance & single supplement (Limited places). For booking and more information contact Patricia Moore 07743936548 or Anne McCambridge 07784953408.

Derry Diocesan Young Adult Community Derry Youth Ministry invites everyone aged 18 – 35 to join their new community every Tuesday evening at 7.30pm, starting 20 October at Claudy Pastoral Centre. Each week features a varied programme including invited speakers, scripture, prayer, food and fellowship alongside organised social events. Everyone is welcome to come along! For more details, please contact yvonne.rooney@derrydiocese .org.

***A Weekend Like No Other* – Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend** St. Mary's, Knock, Co. Mayo Friday 9 April – Sunday 11 April 2027. This residential weekend starts at 7.30pm on Friday and finishes at 4.30pm on Sunday and is open to all married couples. Online booking only at www.marriageencounter.ie

Class Act Theatre Group presents *Fame The Musical* at St Patrick's Hall, Strabane, 2-6 November 2026. Given the popularity of previous Class Act productions, early booking is strongly recommended. Tickets can be booked online via the Class Act Theatre Group website: Www.Classacttheatregroup.Co.Uk/Events

M Dancin' are back with their ever popular *'Another Evening With The Stars'* Country night concert on Tuesday 17th November in St. Patrick's Hall. With a fantastic line up including Shawn Cuddy, Curtis Magee, Owen Mac, Paddy Tracey, Strabane's very own, Uncle Hugo Duncan and The Queen of Country Music, Philomena Begley. Tickets are £15 and available via Strictly By M Dancin' on Facebook or contact Paul on 07926241059

Coffee Morning in Aid of Challenging MND will be held in The Den (Melmount Centre) on Saturday 24 October from 10.30am – 2.00pm. Every donation helps families living with Motor Neurone Disease. Everyone welcome.

Sion Mills Group of Alcohol Anonymous will hold a public information meeting on Wednesday 28 October at 8.30pm in Sion Mills Community Centre. Everyone welcome.

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email@ Dlp@Derrydiocese.Org